Week 8 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, October 28 – 31, 2026 · about two hours each morning · AO Year 2 Term 1 week 8

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate (Fri lighter)
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic, next lesson (21–24), 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,

Recitation: Genesis 1:1 ESV — from your physical Bible; wording not printed here. Optional: say last week's "The Bandog" by heart.

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today," first stanza (add the second only if the first is solid)

Folk song: "The Bold Grenadier" — try the clearer sing-along recording on the shelf page

Math: Ray's Lessons 21–24. One lesson each school day. Oral first. Do not dump the book.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHES / EXTRA
Wed 28	Exodus 18 + Awana	Our Island Story ch. 28, The White Ship	Ray's L21 · copywork · hymn · "Chicken"
Thu 29	Luke 21:1–4 + Awana	Little Duke, ch. 4 second half	Harvey's · Tree in the Trail ch. 6 · folk
Fri 30	hymn (lighter Bible)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 8	Grimm · picture study · composer · handicraft · Romeo (ending)
Sat 31	Luke 21:5–19	Understood Betsy ch. 7	Harvey's · Pilgrim's Progress · evening walk

Books to have open

- ESV Bible (physical copy; references only)
- Ray's New Practical Arithmetic (Mott) — Lessons 21–24
- Harvey's Elementary Grammar (Mott) — two short sittings
- *Our Island Story* ch. 28 · *Little Duke* ch. 4b (printed)
- *Tree in the Trail* — ch. 6 from **your copy** (catch-up; not AO ch. 11–12)
- Grimm's Pantheon — one gentle tale by title (not printed)
- *Burgess Animal Book*, ch. 8 (ch. 9 printed, optional) · *Understood Betsy*, ch. 7
- Awana workbook (Wed + Thu) · McGuffey for Tracy

Two children

Astoria does the whole morning. Tracy joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, Grimm, handicraft, and outside (see her page), with McGuffey pictures nearby during math and copywork.

Weather

Crisp late-October mornings, warm afternoons. Times slide; keep the order.

This week's shifts

Island Story ch. 28, the White Ship. **No CHOW** (AO has none in Week 8). Nesbit's Romeo ends — pre-read it. No Trial and Triumph (Anselm, Week 9). No Cooper chapter.

Readings and page numbers

Every public-domain sitting is printed in full. Edition pages let you find the same place in any copy of that edition; packet pages find it here.

DAY	READING	EDITION · PAGES	THIS PACKET
Wed	Our Island Story ch. 28 · The Story of the White Ship	Stokes / Constable, pp. 129–136	**pp. 11–14**
Wed	"Chicken" (de la Mare)	Constable 1924, p. 13	**p. 15**
Thu	The Little Duke ch. 4, second half	Macmillan, pp. 64–71	**pp. 19–20**
Fri	Burgess Animal Book ch. 8 · Whistler and Yap Yap	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 65–72	**pp. 25–27**
Fri (opt.)	Burgess Animal Book ch. 9 · Two Queer Little Haymakers	Little, Brown 1920, pp. 73–81	**pp. 28–30**
Fri	Romeo and Juliet (Nesbit), the ending	Hertel, Jenkins 1907, pp. 112–118	**pp. 32–33**
Sat	Understood Betsy ch. 7	Henry Holt 1917, pp. 137–161	**pp. 37–42**
Sat	The Pilgrim's Progress · back to the wicket-gate	Dent 1910, pp. 25–28	**pp. 43–44**

FROM YOUR OWN SHELF · NOT PRINTED

- **Bible (ESV)** — Exodus 18 (Wed) · Luke 21:1–4 (Thu) · Luke 21:5–19 (Sat). References only.
- **Tree in the Trail** (Holling) — ch. 6, "The Bearer of Messages" (Thu).
- **Ray's New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 21, 22, 23, 24, one a day.
- **Harvey's Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — next lesson, Thu and Sat.
- **Grimm's Fairy Tales** (Pantheon) — one gentle tale by title (Fri).
- **Awana workbook** — next page, Wed and Thu after Bible.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy's picture pages, any day.

Page numbers come from the Internet Archive scans of each named edition (checked Oct 16, 2026). Other printings of the same book may run a page or two different.

Books on the shelf (and what waits)

What the house owns, what is assigned this week, and what waits. Copyrighted books are never reprinted.

YOU OWN THESE · USE FROM THE PHYSICAL COPY

Tree in the Trail (Holling) — catch-up this week: ch. 6, “The Bearer of Messages” (~15–20 min, Thursday). Weeks 3–7 were ch. 1–5. Do **not** jump to AO Week 8’s ch. 11–12. Never reprint.

Hillyer, A Child’s History of the World — not assigned this week (AO Week 8 has no CHOW). Next is “Knights and Days of Chivalry” (ch. 51 modern / ch. 49 1st ed) in Week 9, from your copy.

Trial and Triumph (Hannula) — not this week. Anselm comes in Week 9. Shelf only. Never reprint.

Seabird (Holling) — owned. Hold until around Week 19.

SHELF WEAVE THIS WEEK · INSIDE THE SAME MORNING

- **Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic** (Mott) — Lessons 21–24; one lesson each school day; oral first.
- **Harvey’s Elementary Grammar** (Mott) — two ~10 min sittings (Thu + Sat), next lesson from your place.
- **Grimm’s Pantheon** — one gentle tale by title (suggested: “Snow-White and Rose-Red”). Never reprint.
- **McGuffey Pictorial Primer** (Mott) — Tracy’s informal picture-page while Astoria does copywork or math.
- **Awana workbook** — Wed + Thu only, 10–15 min AFTER Bible, next page in the physical book. Never reprint.

FOLK SONG · A CLEARER RECORDING

If your “Bold Grenadier” recording is hard to follow, try the plain sing-along version AmblesideOnline links for this song: **youtu.be/9U631tf08sM** (folksandhymns channel). AO’s folk-song page (amblesideonline.org/folksongs) lists two more recordings. Listen once, then sing a verse together.

BUY-AHEAD · WEEKS 10–11

Nothing to buy. Weeks 10–11 use public-domain readings (printed in the packets) and books you already own (Hillyer for Week 11’s CHOW, *Tree in the Trail*). Diane Stanley’s *Joan of Arc* is still around Weeks 22–25 away, so it’s too early to buy.

How to sit with them this week

Short lessons. One reading. Narration. Atmosphere. No teacher-book chapter to finish.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once. Close the book. Let Astoria tell it back in her own order. Do not prompt with “and then what?” A few true sentences are enough. Thank her. Do not correct the facts in the moment.

02 Short lessons

Fifteen to twenty minutes. Stop while she still wants more. Ray’s is one lesson. A long chapter can be split. Do not put Island Story and Little Duke in the same hour.

03 Sad chapters

This week has two sad endings: the White Ship and Romeo and Juliet. Read them plainly, without drama. Let her narration be short if she wants. A walk afterward helps more than talking it through.

04 Wait

After you close the book, wait a full ten seconds before you speak. Silence is not failure. It is the mind at work.

05 Masterly inactivity

Charlotte Mason’s phrase for stepping back. In the afternoons, leave them free to play outside and make things. That freedom is part of the school day, not time off from it.

06 Two children

Tracy joins the stories, songs, poems, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, handicraft, and nature. She is not expected to narrate. Quiet play or McGuffey pictures during math and copywork.

07 Keep the shelf books light

Ray’s, Harvey’s, Awana, Grimm, and TITT all fit into the same morning. There is no second school day for them. Awana only Wed and Thu, after Bible.

08 Habit of attention

Week 8 is the middle of the term. If attention slips, make lessons shorter, not longer. One finished short lesson builds the habit better than a long one she drifts through.

How to teach this week

Island Story ch. 28. Little Duke finishes ch. 4. Exodus 18 and Luke 21. No CHOW, no Trial and Triumph.

01 Bible without a sermon

Wednesday: Exodus 18 (Jethro brings Moses' family; Moses chooses able men to judge the people). Thursday: Luke 21:1–4 (the widow's two small coins) — short, so Awana fits easily. Saturday: Luke 21:5–19 (Jesus speaks of the temple and of hard days ahead). Friday: lighter, hymn first. Open your ESV; never print verse text.

02 Awana, Wed and Thu only

Ten to fifteen minutes AFTER Bible. Next page in their physical Awana book. Never reprint Awana. No Awana Fri or Sat.

03 Ray's Lessons 21–24

Continue after Week 7's Lessons 17–20. One lesson each school day. Oral first when the book allows. Do not dump pages. Tracy plays nearby with McGuffey pictures.

04 Copywork and recitation

New line from de la Mare's "Chicken": *Clapping her platter stood plump Bess*, Best handwriting, then stop. Recitation stays Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (reference only here). Optional: "The Bandog" by heart.

05 Island Story ch. 28 · The White Ship

Printed in full (about 2,200 words). Henry Beauclerc's charter and marriage, then the White Ship. If attention fades, stop at "When Henry had been king for about twenty years" and finish Friday. **Intensity note:** the prince and nearly everyone aboard drown; the king never smiles again. Not graphic, but sad.

06 No CHOW · no Trial and Triumph

AO Week 8 has neither. Knights (CHOW) and Anselm (Trial and Triumph) both come in Week 9. Island Story is all the history this week.

07 Little Duke, ch. 4 second half

Richard and Alberic agree to forget rank at play. Richard dreads the weekly council and stern Count Bernard. Then, coming home from skating, they find King Louis at Rouen, and the King flatters Richard. Printed (about 1,300 words). Narrate what Richard thought of Count Bernard and of the King.

08 Tree in the Trail, ch. 6

From **your copy**. One sitting Thursday, ~15–20 min. Still catching up (Weeks 3–7 were ch. 1–5). Do **not** jump to AO's ch. 11–12. Never reprint TITT.

09 Harvey's, twice

Two ~10-minute sittings (Thu and Sat), the next lesson from where you stopped. Oral and light.

10 Grimm by title only

Open your Pantheon. One gentle tale — suggested: "Snow-White and Rose-Red" (two kind sisters and a bear). If you've read it, use "The Star-Money" or "Mother Holle." Never reprint.

11 Burgess, one chapter (two if it goes well)

Ch. 8, "Whistler and Yap Yap Join the Class" (the marmot and the prairie dog), is the week's chapter. Week 7 printed it as optional — if you already read it, review briefly and go on to ch. 9, "Two Queer Little Haymakers" (Little Chief the pika and Stubtail the mountain beaver), printed as optional. Do not jump to AO's ch. 10–11.

12 What you are not doing

No Cooper chapter. No CHOW. No Trial and Triumph. No Seabird until ~Week 19. No Parables from Nature. No jumping ahead in Tree in the Trail. No Wind in the Willows (finished).

How to teach this week

Betsy, Pilgrim's Progress, Romeo's ending, late-October riches, and a handicraft.

13 Understood Betsy, ch. 7

"Elizabeth Ann Fails in an Examination." Long (about 4,400 words), so read it in two sittings: Saturday up to the break marked in the text, the rest Saturday afternoon or early next week. Betsy fails an examination; Cousin Ann, boiling sap, sends her out to wax sugar on the snow. Then little Molly comes crying for help. On the dark wood road Molly falls into the Wolf Pit, and Betsy gets her out by thinking what Cousin Ann would do. Ask what Betsy did when no grown-up was there.

14 Pilgrim's Progress · back to the gate

Continues right after Evangelist's third point. Evangelist explains Legality, Christian asks whether there is hope, goes back, and knocks at the wicket-gate. Good-will lets him in. About 850 words. Stop at "I rejoice and tremble."

15 Shakespeare · Romeo and Juliet ends (Nesbit)

Pre-read this one. Nesbit's ending has Tybalt's and Mercutio's deaths, the sleeping draught, and both lovers dying. Read it to Astoria only, with Tracy elsewhere. If you think it is too much, read through the banishment and tell the rest in two gentle sentences. AO finishes the play this week either way.

16 Poetry: "Chicken"

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie*. Eight lines: plump Bess calls the hens, and they come running "like feathers blown in a great wind." Both children. Copywork comes from the first line.

17 Dictation (optional, Saturday)

Have her study *plump Bess* and *platter* until she can see them with her eyes shut, then write *Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,* as you say it once. Five minutes. Skip it if she's tired.

18 Term 1 riches

Hymn: "I Bind Unto Myself Today," first stanza (second only if solid). Folk: "The Bold Grenadier," using the clearer recording from the shelf page. Picture study: Rockwell, *Freedom from Want* (the next of the Four Freedoms). Look for two minutes, turn it over, have her describe it. Composer: Bernstein, *Jeremiah*, movement III, "Lamentation," 5–8 minutes while drawing. Nothing copyrighted is printed.

19 Nature · Lost Pines, late October

Watch for monarchs still passing south, yellow-rumped warblers arriving for winter, purple beautyberry and red yaupon berries, and loblolly pine cones opening. Fall asters are in bloom. One drawing, date it, scribe one sentence. Watch for fire ants.

20 Handicraft · pressed-leaf bookmark

Wednesday walk: collect a few small flat leaves and press them inside a heavy book. Friday: arrange them on a strip of card and glue, or seal with clear contact paper. Twenty minutes, then stop. Tracy chooses leaves and pats them down.

21 Preschool corner

Tracy's informal page is in this packet. Same spirit as Week 7: stories and songs, a hen-calling game after "Chicken," McGuffey pictures nearby, no worksheets.

22 Intensity / preview

Sad week: the White Ship (Wed) and Romeo's ending (Fri). Little Duke and Burgess are cheerful. Burgess's prairie dogs live on the same plains as Tree in the Trail. Week 9 brings Exodus 19–20, Island Story's King Stephen, CHOW Knights, and Anselm.

Tracy’s week

She joins what fits. She is not expected to narrate, copy, or sit through math.

01 Join freely

Nature sits and walks, Bible (as long as she’ll sit), the hymn and “The Bold Grenadier,” “Chicken,” the Burgess marmot and prairie-dog chapter, the Grimm tale, picture study, and the leaf bookmark. Not the Romeo ending.

02 Nearby during hard work

McGuffey Pictorial Primer picture-pages, a busy-hands basket, or quiet play while Astoria does Ray’s, copywork, Island Story, Little Duke, or Harvey’s.

03 “Chicken” game

After the poem, Tracy is Bess: she claps an imaginary platter and everyone comes running like hens. Do it once or twice, then stop. No worksheet.

04 Awana days

She may listen near Bible and Awana on Wed and Thu, or play in the same room. She does not do the workbook.

05 Outside is her classroom

Late-October Lost Pines: pine cones, purple beautyberries (look, don’t eat), birds at the feeder, leaves to press. Name one thing each day.

06 Leaf bookmark

She picks the leaves Wednesday and helps press them. Friday she pats them onto the card. Her bookmark doesn’t need to look like anything.

07 Prairie dogs

After Burgess, pop up and down like Yap Yap at his burrow door, and “bark” once. Then stop.

08 What Tracy is not doing

No worksheets, no recitation, no scoring. If she’s fussy, the morning keeps its order and nothing more is added.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 21) · copywork line · *Our Island Story* ch. 28 (printed) · "Chicken" · a heavy book for pressing leaves · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk + leaf hunt** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Collect three or four small flat leaves for Friday's bookmark and press them in a heavy book when you come in. Look for one bird or one berry.

8:25 — **Bible · Exodus 18**

Open your ESV to Exodus 18. Jethro comes to Moses; Moses chooses judges to help him. Read once, close the Bible, narrate, then stop.

8:40 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page in the physical Awana book. Never reprint.

8:55 — **Hymn** TRACY JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today." Sing it; don't explain it.

9:05 — **Ray's · Lesson 21**

Next lesson after Week 7's Lesson 20. Oral first. One lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-page or busy-hands basket.

9:25 — **Copywork + recitation**

Copywork: *Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,* Recitation: Genesis 1:1 from your ESV (wording not printed).

9:40 — **History · Island Story ch. 28**

"Henry I — The Story of the White Ship." Printed. Cap ~25 min; you may stop at "When Henry had been king for about twenty years" and finish Friday. Narrate. **Stop.**

10:10 — **Poem · "Chicken"** TRACY JOINS

Read once. Both children. Then Tracy's hen-calling game, once.

How to teach Wednesday

> **Island Story ch. 28.** Printed in full. Sad ending (the White Ship sinks). No CHOW this week. No Trial and Triumph.

Bible and Awana

Exodus 18 is one calm chapter: Jethro brings Zipporah and the boys, hears all that God did, and advises Moses to share the work of judging. One reading; get a clear narration. Awana after Bible, physical book only.

Ray's Lesson 21

Pick up the Mott Ray's where Week 7 stopped. Oral first. Stop after one lesson even if she's eager.

Island Story

Henry Beauclerc ("fine scholar") gives the English a charter and marries Maud, Edmund Ironside's great-granddaughter. Then the White Ship: the prince's delay, the rock, the turn back for his sister, the butcher Berthold in his sheepskin, the boy who tells the King. Let her tell it in her own order. A timeline mark for 1100–1135 is a nice extra.

Poem

"Chicken" is this week's poem and the copywork. Dorking, Spaniard, Cochin China, and Bantam are kinds of hens. Say the names for fun; no lesson.

Tracy: leaf hunt, Bible as long as she'll sit, hymn, poem and hen game. McGuffey or the busy-hands basket during Ray's and copywork. She can stay for Island Story if she is quiet; it is a sad story.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Bible · Exodus 18

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Exodus 18.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
Jethro visits; Moses appoints judges. One chapter.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Our Island Story · Chapter 28 · Henry I — The Story of the White Ship

*H. E. Marshall, An Island Story: A Child's History of England (New York: Frederick A. Stokes; printed in Edinburgh by T. and A. Constable), ch. XXVIII, **pp. 129–136**. Same text as Our Island Story (London: T. C. & E. C. Jack, 1905). Public domain. Full chapter. · This packet: pp. 11–14*

William the Red died in 1100 A.D. He had no children, so his brother Henry became king after him. Henry was the youngest son of William the Conqueror. He was fond of learning and could read and write better than most people in those days, so he was called Beauclerc, which is French and means 'fine scholar.'

Henry's eldest brother Robert, Duke of Normandy, was still alive, and the Norman barons in England still wanted to have him for their king. So they sent over to France and asked Robert to come to fight again for the crown.

Once more the English people had to choose between the Norman king and the Norman barons. Once more they decided for the King and fought for him, even although William the Red had forgotten his promises and cruelly deceived them. For although Henry's father and mother had been Norman, Henry himself had been born in England, and the English people felt as if that almost made him English. So once more they chose to fight for the King against the barons.

Henry Beauclerc did not repay the people with promises only, as his brother had done. He gave them a written letter, or charter as it was called, in which he promised to do away with many of William the Red's cruel laws, to restore the good laws of Edward, and to lessen the power of the barons.

Later on another king gave the people a much more important charter, but in the meantime the English were very glad to get this one.

Besides giving them this charter, Henry pleased the English very much by marrying the Scottish Princess Maud, or Matilda as she was sometimes called.

Edgar the Ætheling had a sister named Margaret. She married the Scottish King Malcolm III., and this Princess Maud was their daughter, and the great-granddaughter of Edmund Ironside. When Henry married her and she became Queen of England, the English felt that the crown had come back again to their own people, and they were very glad. But the Norman nobles were angry about it. They thought Henry ought to have married a Norman lady.

Although many of the nobles were angry, Henry's marriage did a great deal of good, for other Normans followed the King's example and married English ladies, so that the hatred between the two races began to disappear a little.

Thus it happened that when Robert and his barons came to fight Henry, they were met by an army of English, whose hearts were with their king and who 'nowise feared the Normans.' So hopeless did Robert feel it to be, that he made peace with his brother and went back to Normandy without fighting.

Then Henry punished the rebel barons by taking their lands away from many of them and banishing others. The English helped him and rejoiced at the defeat of the proud barons.

Later on Robert and Henry quarrelled again. Henry sailed over to Normandy with an army of English soldiers, defeated his brother, and took possession of Normandy. So now instead of England belonging to Normandy, Normandy belonged to England.

When Henry had been king for about twenty years, a great and terrible grief came upon him. He and his son, Prince William, had been in Normandy together. Just as they were ready to return to England, a sailor came and begged Henry to honour him by using his ship. 'My father Stephen,' he said, 'steered the ship in which your father sailed over to England when he went to conquer Harold. My father was a good sailor, and he served King William until he

died. I, too, am a sailor like my father. I have a beautiful boat called the White Ship. It is newly rigged and freshly painted, it is manned by fifty trusty sailors, and is in every way worthy of a king. Honour me, as your father honoured my father, and give me leave to steer you to England.'

'I thank you, good Master FitzStephen,' said Henry, 'but I have already made choice of the ship in which I intend to sail, and I cannot change. But,' he added, seeing the man looked disappointed, 'my son, Prince William, is with me and you may steer him and his company over the channel.'

Thomas FitzStephen was very glad when he heard that, and he hurried away to tell his sailors to prepare to receive the prince.

Late in the afternoon King Henry set sail, leaving Prince William to follow in the White Ship. But Prince William was young and gay, and he did not feel inclined to start at once. He stayed on shore drinking and feasting and making merry with his friends. When at last he did go on board, he ordered the captain to give the sailors three barrels of good red wine with which to drink his health. So there was still further delay. As was usual in those days, priests came to bless the ship before it started, but the prince and his gay companions laughed at them, and the sailors, whom the wine had made merry, chased them away.

One of the King's friends, who had been left behind with the prince, now urged the captain to start. 'Oh, there is no hurry,' said FitzStephen, 'my beautiful White Ship has sails like the wings of a bird. She skims over the water swifter than a swallow. We can easily overtake the King and be in England before him.'

At last they started. The deck was crowded with fine ladies and gay gentlemen. These ladies and gentlemen had many servants, so that, together with the sailors, there were about three hundred people on board the ship.

The sails were set, the sailors bent to the oars, and to the sound of song and laughter the gay ship left the harbour, skimming over the waves like a beautiful bird, as the captain had said.

It was a clear and frosty winter's evening. The red sun had sunk and a silver moon shone brightly. All was merriment and laughter when, suddenly, there was an awful crash. The ship seemed to shiver from end to end and then stand still. The next minute it began to sink. It had struck upon a rock.

One fearful wail of agony rose from the hearts of three hundred people, breaking the stillness of the night. Far away over the sea Henry heard that cry. 'What is it?' he asked, straining anxious eyes through the darkness.

'Only some night bird, sire,' replied the captain.

'Methought it was some soul in distress,' said Henry, still looking back over the sea, anxious he knew not why.

On the White Ship all was terrible confusion. Without losing a moment FitzStephen thrust the prince into the only small boat, and bade the sailors row off. He at least must be saved, though all the rest should perish.

The prince, hardly knowing what had happened, allowed the sailors to row away from the sinking vessel. But suddenly a voice called to him, 'Ah, William, William, do you leave me to perish?'

It was the voice of his sister Marie.

William was careless and selfish, but he loved his sister. He could not leave her. 'Go back,' he said to the sailors, 'go back, we must take my sister too.'

'We dare not, sire,' replied the boatmen. 'We dare not, we must go on.'

'You dare not,' cried the prince, 'am I not the son of the King of England? Obey me.'

The prince spoke so sternly that the men turned the boat and went back to the sinking ship.

As the boat drew near, the Princess Marie, with a cry of joy, leaped into her brother's arms. But, alas! many others, eager to be saved, crowded into the little boat. The sailors tried in vain to keep them back, the little boat was overturned, and the prince was drowned.

The White Ship sank fast, until only the mast was seen above the water. Clinging to it were two men—all that were left of that gay company. One of these men was a noble called Geoffrey de l'Aigle. The other was a poor butcher of Rouen, called Berthold.

As they clung there, a third man appeared, swimming through the waves. It was the captain, FitzStephen.

'What of the prince?' he asked.

'The prince is drowned,' replied Geoffrey.

'Ah, woe is me!' cried FitzStephen, and throwing up his arms, he sank.

Hour after hour the two men clung to the mast. They were numbed with cold and perishing from hunger. Again and again, as long as they had strength, they called aloud for help. But there was no one to hear. The bright stars twinkled overhead and the moon shone calmly, making paths of shining silver over the still water. But no voice answered their cries.

All through the terrible long night the noble and the butcher talked and tried to comfort each other. But towards morning the noble became exhausted. 'Good-bye, friend,' he whispered to Berthold, 'God keep you. I can hold out no longer.' Then he slipped into the water, and Berthold was left alone.

When the wintry sun rose, Berthold, faint and benumbed, was still clinging to the mast. He was the poorest of all those who had sailed in the beautiful White Ship. While the others had been dressed in silk and satin and velvet, his coat was of sheepskin, and perhaps that helped to save him, for the rough skin kept out the cold and wet far better than a coat of satin could have done.

It was beginning to grow light when three fishermen, passing in their boat, caught sight of something floating in the water. They rowed near to see what it was, and found the poor butcher almost dead from cold and hunger.

The fishermen lifted him into their boat and took him home. When they had warmed and fed him, and he could speak again, he told his dreadful story.

Alas, what news to carry to England! There was mourning and tears among the nobles when they heard it, for almost every one among them had lost a son or a brother.

But who should tell the King? No one dared. The nobles knew that Henry loved his son above everything on earth, so for three days, in spite of his anxious questions, no one dared to tell him the truth. When alone they wept for their dear ones, but in presence of the King they put away their tears and tried to smile and jest as usual.

At last one of the nobles, taking his little son by the hand, and whispering to him, 'Go, tell the King,' gently pushed the child into the room where Henry was sitting.

The little boy felt frightened and shy at finding himself alone with the stern King, although he hardly understood how terrible a tale he had to tell. Half sobbing with excitement and fear, he knelt before Henry and stammered out the story.

As Henry listened, his hands clutched his robe, his lips moved, but no sound came. Then suddenly he fell senseless to the floor, and the little boy, now quite frightened, burst into loud sobbing.

At the sound of the fall the nobles rushed into the room. They lifted the King and placed him upon a couch. He lay there with white face and closed eyes. When he opened his eyes again there was a look in them that no one had seen before; his face was lined and drawn with sorrow, and no one ever saw him smile again.

Henry had no other son, but he had a daughter who was called Matilda, as her mother had been. He resolved that this daughter should be queen after he was dead.

In those days it was thought strange for a country to be ruled by a woman, and the haughty Norman nobles hated the thought of it. But Henry was so strong and stern that he forced them to promise that Matilda should be queen. How they kept that promise you shall hear.

After Prince William's death, Henry spent a great deal of his time in Normandy. He was there when he died. It is said that his death was caused by eating too many lampreys. Lampreys are fish something like eels.

Henry was very fierce and stern, but he was wise, and in those days it was necessary for a king to be stern in order to keep the strong barons in check. He loved justice so much that he was called the Lion of Justice. He took the side of the English people against the Norman barons, and the English repaid him by being true to him. We read of Henry that, 'Good he was and mickle awe was of him. No man durst misdo with other in his day. Peace he made for man and deer.'

Peace he made and peace he loved, so that he was called the 'peace-loving king.'

Kneeling beside King Henry, as he lay dying, the Archbishop of Rouen prayed, 'God give him the peace he loved.'

> **End of chapter.** Narrate. Next week: ch. 29, The Story of King Stephen.

READ THIS · WEDNESDAY

Chicken

Walter de la Mare, Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes (London: Constable; 1924 printing), ***p. 13****. Text: Project Gutenberg #3753 (1913). Public domain. This week's copywork comes from here. · This packet: p. 15*

Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,
And all across the green
Came scampering in, on wing and claw,
Chicken fat and lean:—
Dorking, Spaniard, Cochin China,
Bantams sleek and small,
Like feathers blown in a great wind,
They came at Bessie's call.

> **Copywork:** Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · Awana workbook · Ray's (Lesson 22) · *The Little Duke* ch. 4 second half (printed) · *Tree in the Trail* (your copy, ch. 6) · Harvey's · folk song recording · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Porch or backyard, twenty minutes. Listen for a new winter bird — yellow-rumped warblers chip from the pines about now.

8:25 — **Bible · Luke 21:1–4**

The widow's offering. Short. Read once, narrate, stop.

8:35 — **Awana** AFTER BIBLE

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page. Then put it away.

8:50 — **Folk song** TRACY JOINS

"The Bold Grenadier." Try the clearer sing-along recording (shelf page). One verse.

9:00 — **Ray's · Lesson 22**

One lesson. Oral first. Tracy nearby with McGuffey.

9:20 — **Tales · Little Duke ch. 4b**

Printed. Fair play with Alberic, the dull council, skating, and King Louis comes to Rouen. Cap ~20 min. Narrate.

9:45 — **Geography · Tree in the Trail ch. 6**

From your copy, ~15–20 min. Narrate. Do not jump ahead to AO's ch. 11.

10:10 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

About ten minutes, next lesson, oral and light. Then stop.

How to teach Thursday

> **Little Duke finishes ch. 4.** Tree in the Trail from your copy. Harvey's first sitting. Copywork can go here if Wednesday was full.

Bible and Awana

Luke 21:1–4 is only four verses: the rich give gifts, and a poor widow puts in two small coins. Ask who gave the most, and let her answer. Awana after.

Little Duke

Alberic won't play unless the game is fair, so the boys agree to forget rank at play. Richard keeps at his lessons only because it was his father's wish, and he hates sitting in council under Count Bernard's eye. Then King Louis arrives, praises Richard, and Richard starts thinking Count Bernard is unkind. Ask her whether the King's praise seems trustworthy. Next week the story turns.

Tree in the Trail

Chapter 6, "The Bearer of Messages," from your physical book. One sitting. Let her find the place on the trail map if your copy has one. Never reprint.

Harvey's

First of two short sittings. Oral. Next lesson from your place.

Tracy: nature, Bible, folk song. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's. She may listen to Little Duke if she is content.

READ THIS · THURSDAY

Bible · Luke 21:1–4

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 21:1–4.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The widow’s offering. Short — Awana follows.

The Little Duke · Chapter 4 · second half

*Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke (London & New York: Macmillan), ch. IV, second half, **pp. 64–71** (Macmillan printing scanned at the Internet Archive). Text: Project Gutenberg #3048, from the 1905 Macmillan edition. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 19–20*

"I can't help it," said Alberic; "if you take all the best chances to yourself, 'tis no sport for me. I will do your bidding, as you are the Duke, but I cannot like it."

"Never mind my being Duke, but play as we used to do."

"Then let us play as I did with Bertrand's sons at Montemar. I was their Baron, as you are my Duke, but my mother said there would be no sport unless we forgot all that at play."

"Then so we will. Come, begin again, Alberic, and you shall have the first turn."

However, Alberic was quite as courteous and respectful to the Duke when they were not at play, as the difference of their rank required; indeed, he had learnt much more of grace and courtliness of demeanour from his mother, a Provencal lady, than was yet to be found among the Normans. The Chaplain of Montemar had begun to teach him to read and write, and he liked learning much better than Richard, who would not have gone on with Father Lucas's lessons at all, if Abbot Martin of Jumieges had not put him in mind that it had been his father's especial desire.

What Richard most disliked was, however, the being obliged to sit in council. The Count of Harcourt did in truth govern the dukedom, but nothing could be done without the Duke's consent, and once a week at least, there was held in the great hall of Rollo's tower, what was called a *Parlement*, or "a talkation," where Count Bernard, the Archbishop, the Baron de Centeville, the Abbot of Jumieges, and such other Bishops, Nobles, or Abbots, as might chance to be at Rouen, consulted on the affairs of Normandy; and there the little Duke always was forced to be present, sitting up in his chair of state, and hearing rather than listening to, questions about the repairing and guarding of Castles, the asking of loans from the vassals, the appeals from the Barons of the Exchequer, who were then Nobles sent through the duchy to administer justice, and the discussions about the proceedings of his neighbours, King Louis of France, Count Foulques of Anjou, and Count Herluin of Montreuil, and how far the friendship of Hugh of Paris, and Alan of Brittany might be trusted.

Very tired of all this did Richard grow, especially when he found that the Normans had made up their minds not to attempt a war against the wicked Count of Flanders. He sighed most wearily, yawned again and again, and moved restlessly about in his chair; but whenever Count Bernard saw him doing so, he received so severe a look and sign that he grew perfectly to dread the eye of the fierce old Dane. Bernard never spoke to him to praise him, or to enter into any of his pursuits; he only treated him with the grave distant respect due to him as a Prince, or else now and then spoke a few stern words to him of reproof for this restlessness, or for some other childish folly.

Used as Richard was to be petted and made much of by the whole house of Centeville, he resented this considerably in secret, disliked and feared the old Count, and more than once told Alberic de Montemar, that as soon as he was fourteen, when he would be declared of age, he should send Count Bernard to take care of his own Castle of Harcourt, instead of letting him sit gloomy and grim in the Castle hall in the evening, spoiling all their sport.

Winter had set in, and Osmond used daily to take the little Duke and Alberic to the nearest sheet of ice, for the Normans still prided themselves on excelling in skating, though they had long since left the frost-bound streams and lakes of Norway.

One day, as they were returning from the ice, they were surprised, even before they entered the Castle court, by hearing the trampling of horses' feet, and a sound of voices.

"What may this mean?" said Osmond. "There must surely be a great arrival of the vassals. The Duke of Brittany, perhaps."

“Oh,” said Richard, piteously, “we have had one council already this week. I hope another is not coming!”

“It must import something extraordinary,” proceeded Osmond. “It is a mischance that the Count of Harcourt is not at Rouen just now.”

Richard thought this no mischance at all, and just then, Alberic, who had run on a little before, came back exclaiming, “They are French. It is the Frank tongue, not the Norman, that they speak.”

“So please you, my Lord,” said Osmond, stopping short, “we go not rashly into the midst of them. I would I knew what were best to do.”

Osmond rubbed his forehead and stood considering, while the two boys looked at him anxiously. In a few seconds, before he had come to any conclusion, there came forth from the gate a Norman Squire, accompanied by two strangers.

“My Lord Duke,” said he to Richard, in French, “Sir Eric has sent me to bring you tidings that the King of France has arrived to receive your homage.”

“The King!” exclaimed Osmond.

“Ay!” proceeded the Norman, in his own tongue, “Louis himself, and with a train looking bent on mischief. I wish it may portend good to my Lord here. You see I am accompanied. I believe from my heart that Louis meant to prevent you from receiving a warning, and taking the boy out of his clutches.”

“Ha! what?” said Richard, anxiously. “Why is the King come? What must I do?”

“Go on now, since there is no help for it,” said Osmond.

“Greet the king as becomes you, bend the knee, and pay him homage.”

Richard repeated over to himself the form of homage that he might be perfect in it, and walked on into the court; Alberic, Osmond, and the rest falling back as he entered. The court was crowded with horses and men, and it was only by calling out loudly, “The Duke, the Duke,” that Osmond could get space enough made for them to pass. In a few moments Richard had mounted the steps and stood in the great hall.

In the chair of state, at the upper end of the room, sat a small spare man, of about eight or nine-and-twenty, pale, and of a light complexion, with a rich dress of blue and gold. Sir Eric and several other persons stood respectfully round him, and he was conversing with the Archbishop, who, as well as Sir Eric, cast several anxious glances at the little Duke as he advanced up the hall. He came up to the King, put his knee to the ground, and was just beginning, “Louis, King of France, I—“ when he found himself suddenly lifted from the ground in the King’s arms, and kissed on both cheeks. Then setting him on his knee, the King exclaimed, “And is this the son of my brave and noble friend, Duke William? Ah! I should have known it from his likeness. Let me embrace you again, dear child, for your father’s sake.”

Richard was rather overwhelmed, but he thought the King very kind, especially when Louis began to admire his height and free-spirited bearing, and to lament that his own sons, Lothaire and Carloman, were so much smaller and more backward. He caressed Richard again and again, praised every word he said—Fru Astrida was nothing to him; and Richard began to say to himself how strange and unkind it was of Bernard de Harcourt to like to find fault with him, when, on the contrary, he deserved all this praise from the King himself.

> **End of chapter 4.** Next week: chapter 5, first half.

OPEN YOUR COPY · THURSDAY

Tree in the Trail · Chapter 6 · The Bearer of Messages

Holling C. Holling — owned copy · never reprinted in this packet

Open your Tree in the Trail to chapter 6.

One sitting, ~15–20 min. Read once, narrate, stop.

Catch-up: Weeks 3–7 were ch. 1–5. Do not jump to AO Week 8's ch. 11–12.

Never reprint Holling.

READ THIS · THURSDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. First sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

Friday

HAVE READY

Hymn words · Ray's (Lesson 23) · *Burgess* ch. 8 (printed; ch. 9 optional) · Grimm's Pantheon · Rockwell *Freedom from Want* (book or screen) · Bernstein *Jeremiah* III · pressed leaves, card strip, glue or contact paper · Nesbit Romeo (printed) · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature sit** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Look for monarchs, fall asters, beautyberry.

8:25 — **Hymn · lighter Bible day**

Sing the first stanza. No new passage today.

8:35 — **Ray's · Lesson 23**

One lesson. Oral first.

8:55 — **Nature lore · Burgess ch. 8** TRACY JOINS

Whistler the Marmot and Yap Yap the Prairie Dog. Printed. Narrate. Ch. 9 (the pika and the mountain beaver) only if she asks for more.

9:20 — **Grimm · by title** TRACY JOINS

From your Pantheon — "Snow-White and Rose-Red" suggested. One tale. Narrate.

9:35 — **Picture study + composer** TRACY JOINS

Rockwell *Freedom from Want*: look, turn it over, describe it. Then Bernstein *Jeremiah* III while she draws.

9:55 — **Handicraft · leaf bookmark** TRACY JOINS

Arrange Wednesday's pressed leaves on a card strip; glue or seal. Twenty minutes, then stop.

10:20 — **Shakespeare · Romeo ends**

Astoria only. Pre-read; stop at the banishment if you prefer and tell the rest gently.

How to teach Friday

> **No Awana. Lighter Bible.** Protect the Burgess narration. Handicraft before Shakespeare. The Romeo ending is for Astoria only — pre-read it.

Burgess

Ch. 8 is the week's chapter: Whistler the Marmot, a mountain cousin of Johnny Chuck, and Yap Yap the Prairie Dog of the plains. If you already read it as Week 7's optional sitting, review it in one minute and go on to ch. 9, "Two Queer Little Haymakers" (the pika and the mountain beaver).

Grimm

"Snow-White and Rose-Red" (or "The Star-Money" / "Mother Holle" if it's familiar). One tale. Close the book. Let her tell it.

Picture study and composer

Freedom from Want is the Thanksgiving-table painting, the third of the Four Freedoms. Ask her who is at the table and what is on it. Bernstein's "Lamentation" is sung by a mezzo-soprano; the words come from the book of Lamentations. Just listen.

Handicraft

Pressed-leaf bookmark. Small flat leaves work best. If they aren't dry yet, press them another day and do the bookmark Saturday afternoon.

Romeo and Juliet (Nesbit)

Tybalt kills Mercutio and Romeo kills Tybalt; Romeo is banished; Juliet takes the friar's sleeping draught; the message to Romeo goes astray; both die in the tomb. Read it plainly, or stop at the banishment and summarize. Narration can be one sentence: what went wrong.

Tracy: nature, hymn, Burgess, Grimm, picture study, music, leaf bookmark. Not the Romeo ending. McGuffey during Ray's.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 8 · Whistler and Yap Yap Join the Class

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. VIII, ***pp. 65–72****. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. Full chapter. · This packet: pp. 25–27*

Johnny Chuck was the first one on hand the next morning. The fact is, Johnny was quite excited over the discovery that he had some near relatives. He always had supposed that the Woodchucks were a family by themselves. Now that he knew that he had some close relatives, he was filled with quite as much curiosity as ever Peter Rabbit possessed. Just as soon as Old Mother Nature was ready to begin, Johnny Chuck was ready with a question. “If you please,” said he, “who are my nearest relatives?”

“The Marmots of the Far West,” replied Old Mother Nature. “You know, you are a Marmot, and these cousins of yours out there are a great deal like you in a general way. The biggest and handsomest of all is Whistler, who lives in the mountains of the Northwest. The fact is, he is the biggest of all the Marmot family.”

“Is he much bigger than Johnny Chuck?” asked Peter Rabbit.

“Considerably bigger,” replied Old Mother Nature, nodding her head. “Considerably bigger. I should think he would weight twice as much as Johnny.”

Johnny’s eyes opened very wide. “My!” he exclaimed, “I should like to see him. Does he look like me?”

“In his shape he does,” said Old Mother Nature, “but he has a very much handsomer coat. His coat is a mixture of dark brown and white hairs which give him a grayish color. The upper part of his head, his feet and nails are black, and so are his ears. A black band runs from behind each ear down to his neck. His chin is pure white and there is white on his nose. Underneath he is a light, rusty color. His fur is thicker and softer than yours, Johnny; this is because he lives where it is colder. His tail is larger, somewhat bushier, and is a blackish-brown.”

“If you please, why is he called Whistler?” asked Johnny Chuck eagerly.

“Because he has a sharp, clear whistle which can be heard a very long distance,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He sits up just as you do. If he sees danger approaching he whistles, as a warning to all his relatives within hearing.”

“I suppose it is foolish to ask if he lives in a hole in the ground as Johnny Chuck does,” spoke up Peter Rabbit.

“He does,” replied Old Mother Nature. “All Marmots live in holes in the ground, but Whistler lives in entirely different country. He lives up on the sides of the mountains, often so high that no trees grow there and the ground is rocky. He digs his hole down in between the rocks.”

“It must be a nice, safe hole,” said Peter. “I guess he doesn’t have to worry about being dug out by Reddy fox.”

“You guessed quite right,” laughed Old Mother Nature. “Nevertheless, he has reason to fear being dug out. You see, out where he lives, Grizzly, the big cousin of Buster Bear, also lives, and Grizzly is very fond of a Marmot dinner when he can get one. He is so big and strong and has such great claws that he can pull the rocks apart and dig Whistler out. By the way, I forgot to tell you that Whistler is also called the Gray Marmot and the Hoary Marmot. He lives on grass and other green things and, like Johnny Chuck, gets very fat in the fall and then sleeps all winter. There are one or two other Marmots in the Far West who live farther south than does Whistler, but their habits are much the same as those of Whistler and Johnny Chuck. None of them are social. I mean by that you never find two Marmot homes very close together. In this they differ from Johnny’s smaller cousin, Yap Yap the Prairie Dog. Yap Yap wouldn’t be happy if he didn’t have close neighbors of his own kind. He has one of the most social natures of all my little people.”

“Tell us about him,” begged Happy Jack Squirrel before Johnny Chuck, who is naturally slow, could ask for the same thing.

“Yap Yap is the smallest of the Marmot family,” said Old Mother Nature. “In a way he is about as closely related to the Ground Squirrels as he is to the Marmots. Johnny Chuck has only four claws on each front foot, but Yap Yap has five, just as the Ground Squirrels have. He looks very much like a small Chuck dressed in light yellow-brown. His tail for the most part is the same color as his coat, but the end is black, though there is one member of the family whose tail has a white tip. In each cheek is a small pouch, that is, a small pocket, and this is one of the things that shows how closely related to the Spermophiles he is.

“As I said before, Yap Yap is very social by nature. He lives on the great open plains of the West and Southwest, frequently where it is very dry and rain seldom falls. When you find his home you are sure to find the homes of many more Prairie Dogs very close at hand. Sometimes there are hundreds and hundreds of homes, making a regular town. This is because the Prairie Dogs dearly love the company of their own kind.”

“Does Yap Yap dig the same kind of a hole that I do?” asked Johnny Chuck.

“In a way it is like yours,” replied Old Mother Nature, “but at the same time it is different. In the first place, it goes almost straight down for a long distance. In the second place there is no mound of sand in front of Yap Yap’s doorway. Instead of that the doorway is right in the very middle of the mound of sand. One reason for this is that when it does rain out where Yap Yap lives it rains very hard indeed, so that the water stands on the ground for a short time. The ground being flat, a lot of water would run down into Yap Yap’s home and make him most uncomfortable if he did not do something to keep it out. So he brings the sand out and piles it all the way around his doorway and presses it down with his nose. In that way he builds up a firm mound which he uses for two purposes; one is to keep the water from running down the hole, and the other is as a sort of watch tower. He sits on the top of his mound to watch for his enemies. His cousins with the white tail digs a hole more like yours.

“Yap Yap loves to visit his neighbors and to have them visit him. They are lively little people and do a great deal of talking among themselves. The instant one of them sees an enemy he gives a signal. Then every Prairie Dog scampers for his own hole and dives in head first. Almost at once he pops his head out again to see what the danger may be.”

“How can he do that without going clear to the bottom to turn around?” demanded Peter.

“I wondered if any of you would think of that question,” chuckled Old Mother Nature. “Just a little way down from the entrance Yap Yap digs a little room at one side of his tunnel. All he has to do is to scramble into that, turn around and then pop his head out. As I said before, his tunnel goes down very deep; then it turns and goes almost equally far underground. Down there he has a nice little bedroom. Sometimes he has more than one.”

“If it is so dry out where he lives, how does he get water to drink?” asked Happy Jack.

“He doesn’t have to drink,” replied Old Mother Nature. “Some folks think that he digs down until he finds water way down underneath, but this isn’t so. He doesn’t have to have water. He gets all the moisture he needs from the green things he eats.”

“I suppose, like the rest of us, he has lots of enemies?” said Peter.

Old Mother Nature nodded. “Of course,” said she. “Old Man Coyote and Reddy Fox are very fond of Prairie Dog. So are members of the Hawk family. Then in some places there is a cousin of Shadow the Weasel called the Black-footed Ferret. He is to be feared most of all because he can follow Yap Yap down into his hole. There is a cousin of Hooty the Owl called the Burrowing Owl because it builds its home in a hole in the ground. You are likely to find many Burrowing Owls living in Prairie Dog villages. Also you are apt to find Buzztail the Rattlesnake there.

“A lot of people believe that Yap Yap, Buzztail and the little Burrowing Owl are the best of friends and often live together in the same hole. This isn’t so at all. Buzztail is very fond of young Prairie Dog and so is the Burrowing Owl. Rather than dig a hole for himself the Owl will sometimes take possession of one of Yap Yap’s deserted holes. If he should make a mistake and enter a hole in which Yap Yap was at home, the chances are that Yap Yap would kill

the Owl for he knows that the Owl is an enemy. Buzztail the Rattlesnake also makes use of Prairie Dog holes, but it is safe to say that if there are any Prairie Dog babies down there they never live to see what the outside world is like. So Buzztail and the Burrowing Owl are really enemies instead of friends of Yap Yap, the Prairie Dog."

"Why is he called a Dog?" asked Peter.

Old Mother Nature laughed right out. "Goodness knows," said she. "He doesn't look like a Dog and he doesn't act like a Dog, so why people should call him a Dog I don't know, unless it is because of his habit of barking, and even his bark isn't at all like a Dog's—not nearly so much so as the bark of Reddy Fox. Now I guess this will do for to-day. Haven't you little folks had enough of school?"

"No," cried Peter Rabbit and Jumper the Hare and Happy Jack and Chatterer the Red Squirrel and Striped Chipmunk and Johnny Chuck. "We want to know about the rest of the members of the order of Rodents or Gnawers," added Peter. "Of course in a way they are sort of related to us and we want to know about them."

Old Mother Nature laughed good-naturedly. "All right," said she, "come again to-morrow morning and we'll see what more we can learn."

> **End of chapter 8.** Narrate. Chapter 9 follows as an optional second sitting.

OPTIONAL · FRIDAY

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 9 · Two Queer Little Haymakers

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (Boston: Little, Brown, 1920), ch. IX, ***pp. 73–81****. Optional second sitting. Text: Project Gutenberg #2441. Public domain. · This packet: pp. 28–30*

There is nothing like a little knowledge to make one want more. Johnny Chuck, who had gone to school only because Old Mother Nature had sent for him, had become as full of curiosity as Peter Rabbit. The discovery that he had a big, handsome cousin, Whistler the Marmot, living in the mountains of the Far West, had given Johnny something to think about. It seemed to Johnny such a queer place for a member of his family to live that he wanted to know more about it. So Johnny had a question all ready when Old Mother Nature called school to order the next morning.

“If you please, Mother Nature,” said he, “does my cousin, Whistler, have any neighbors up among those rocks where he lives?”

“He certainly does,” replied Old Mother Nature, nodding her head. “He has for a near neighbor one of the quaintest and most interesting little members of the big order to which you all belong. And that order is what?” she asked abruptly.

“The order of Rodents,” replied Peter Rabbit promptly.

“Right, Peter,” replied Old Mother Nature, smiling at Peter. “I asked that just to see if you really are learning. I wanted to make sure that I am not wasting my time with you little folks. Now this little neighbor of Whistler is Little Chief Hare.”

Instantly Peter Rabbit and Jumper the Hare pricked up their long ears and became more interested than ever, if that were possible. “I thought you had told us all about our family,” cried Jumper, “but you didn’t mention Little Chief.”

“No,” said Old Mother Nature, “I didn’t, and the reason I didn’t was because Little Chief isn’t a member of your family. He is called Little Chief Hare, but he isn’t a Hare at all, although he looks much like a small Rabbit with short hind legs and rounded ears. He has a family all to himself and should be called a Pika. Some folks do call him that, but more call him a Cony, and some call him the Crying Hare. This is because he uses his voice a great deal, which is something no member of the Hare family does. In size he is just about as big as one of your half-grown babies, Peter, so, you see, he really is a very little fellow. His coat is grayish-brown. His ears are of good size, but instead of being long, are round. He has small bright eyes. His legs are short, his hind legs being very little longer than his front ones. He has hair on the soles of his feet just like the members of the hare family.”

“What about his tail?” piped up Peter Rabbit. You know Peter is very much interested in tails.

Old Mother Nature smiled. “He is worse off than you, Peter,” said she, “for he hasn’t any at all. That is, he hasn’t any that can be seen. He lives way up among the rocks of the great mountains above where the trees grow and often is a very near neighbor to Whistler.”

“I suppose that means that he makes his home down in under rocks, the same as Whistler does,” spoke up Johnny Chuck.

“Right,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He is such a little fellow that he can get through very narrow places, and he has his home and barns way down in among the rocks.”

“Barns!” exclaimed Happy Jack Squirrel. “Barns! What do you mean by barns?”

Old Mother Nature laughed. “I just call them barns,” said she, “because they are the places where he stores away his hay, just as Farmer Brown stores away his hay in his barn. I suppose you would call them storehouses.”

At the mention of hay, Peter Rabbit sat bolt upright and his eyes were wide open with astonishment. “Did you say hay?” he exclaimed. “Where under the sun does he get hay way up there, and what does he want of it?”

There was a twinkle in Old Mother Nature’s eyes as she replied, “He makes that hay just as you see Farmer Brown make hay every summer. It is what he lives on in the winter and in bad weather. Little Chief knows just as much about the proper way of making hay as Farmer Brown does. Even way up among the rocks there are places where grass and peas-vines and other green things grow. Little Chief lives on these in summer. But he is as wise and thrifty as any Squirrel, another way in which he differs from the Hare family. He cuts them when they are ready for cutting and spreads them out on the rocks to dry in the sun. He knows that if he should take them down into his barns while they are fresh and green they would sour and spoil; so he never stores them away until they are thoroughly dry. Then, of course, they are hay, for hay is nothing but sun-dried grass cut before it has begun to die. When his hay is just as dry as it should be, he takes it down and stores it away in his barns, which are nothing but little caves down in among the rocks. There he has it for use in winter when there is no green food.

“Little Chief is so nearly the color of the rocks that it takes sharp eyes to see him when he is sitting still. He has a funny little squeaking voice, and he uses it a great deal. It is a funny voice because it is hard to tell just where it comes from. It seems to come from nowhere in particular. Sometimes he can be heard squeaking way down in his home under the rocks. Like Johnny Chuck, he prefers to sleep at night and be abroad during the day. Because he is so small he must always be on the lookout for enemies. At the first hint of danger he scampers to safety in among the rocks, and there he scolds whoever has frightened him. There is no more loveable little person in all my great family than this little haymaker of the mountains of the Great West.”

“That haymaking is a pretty good idea of Little Chief’s,” remarked Peter Rabbit, scratching a long ear with a long hind foot. “I’ve a great mind to try it myself.”

Everybody laughed right out, for everybody knew just how easy-going and thriftless Peter was. Peter himself grinned. He couldn’t help it.

“That would be a very good idea, Peter,” said Old Mother Nature. “By the way, there is another haymaker out in those same great mountains of the Far West.”

“Who?” demanded Peter and Johnny Chuck and Happy Jack Squirrel, all in the same breath.

“Stubtail the Mountain Beaver,” declared Peter promptly. “I suppose Stubtail is his cousin.”

Old Mother Nature shook her head. “No,” said she. “No. Stubtail and Paddy are no more closely related than the rest of you. Stubtail isn’t a Beaver at all. His proper name is Sewellel. Sometimes he is called Showt’l and sometimes the Boomer, and sometimes the Chehalis, but most folks call him the Mountain Beaver.”

“Is it because he looks like Paddy the Beaver?” Striped Chipmunk asked.

“No,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He looks more like Jerry Muskrat than he does like Paddy. He is about Jerry’s size and looks very much as Jerry would if he had no tail.”

“Hasn’t he any tail at all?” asked Peter.

“Yes, he has a little tail, a little stub of a tail, but it is so small that to look at him you would think he hadn’t any,” replied Old Mother Nature. “He is found out in the same mountains of the Far West where Whistler and Little Chief live, but instead of living way up high among the rocks he is at home down in the valleys where the ground is soft and the trees grow thickly. Stubtail has no use for rocks. He wants soft, wet ground where he can tunnel and tunnel to his heart’s content. In one thing Stubtail is very like Yap Yap the Prairie Dog.”

“What is that?” asked Johnny Chuck quickly, for, you know, Yap Yap is Johnny’s cousin.

“In his social habits,” replied Old Mother Nature. “Stubtail isn’t fond of living alone. He wants company of his own kind. So wherever you find Stubtail you are likely to find many of his family. They like to go visiting back and forth. They make little paths between their homes and all about through the thick ferns, and they keep these little paths free

and clear, so that they may run along them easily. Some of these little paths lead into long tunnels. These are made for safety. Usually the ground is so wet that there will be water running in the bottoms of these little tunnels."

"What kind of a house does Stubtail have?" inquired Johnny Chuck interestedly.

"A hole in the ground, of course," replied Old Mother Nature. "It is dug where the ground is drier than where the runways are made. Mrs. Stubtail makes a nest of dried ferns and close by they build two or three storehouses, for Stubtail and Mrs. Stubtail are thrifty people."

"I suppose he fills them with hay, for you said he is a haymaker," remarked Happy Jack Squirrel, who is always interested in storehouses.

"Yes," replied Old Mother Nature, "he puts hay in them. He cuts grasses, ferns, pea-vines and other green plants and carries them in little bundles to the entrance to his tunnel. There he piles them on sticks so as to keep them off he damp ground and so that the air can help dry them out. When they are dry, he takes them inside and stores them away. He also stores other things. He likes the roots of ferns. He cuts tender, young twigs from bushes and stores away some of these. He is fond of bark. In winter he is quite as active as in summer and tunnels about under the snow. Then he sometimes has Peter Rabbit's bad habit of killing trees by gnawing bark all around as high up as he can reach."

"Can he climb trees?" asked Chatterer the Red Squirrel.

"Just about as much as Johnny Chuck can," replied Old Mother Nature. "Sometimes he climbs up in low bushes or in small, low-branching trees to cut off tender shoots, but he doesn't do much of this sort of thing. His home is the ground. He is most active at night, but where undisturbed, is out more or less during the day. When he wants to cut off a twig he sits up like a Squirrel and holds the twig in his hands while he bites it off with his sharp teeth."

"You didn't tell us what color his coat is," said Peter Rabbit.

"I told you he looked very much like Jerry Muskrat," replied Old Mother Nature. "His coat is brown, much the color of Jerry's, but his fur is not nearly so soft and fine."

"I suppose he has enemies just as the rest of us little people have," said Peter.

"Of course," replied Old Mother Nature. "All little people have enemies, and most big ones too, for that matter. King Eagle is one and Yowler the Bob Cat is another. They are always watching for Stubtail. That is why he digs so many tunnels. He can travel under the ground then. My goodness, how time flies! Scamper home, all of you, for I have too much to do to talk any more to-day."

> **End of chapter 9.** If you skip it, it opens Week 9.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · FROM YOUR SHELF

Grimm’s Fairy Tales · one gentle tale

Pantheon edition · owned copy · by title only · never reprinted

Open your Pantheon Grimm.

Suggested: *Snow-White and Rose-Red*. Alternates: *The Star-Money* or *Mother Holle* if it’s familiar.

Find it by title in the contents. Read once. Close the book. Narrate. Never reprint.

READ THIS · FRIDAY · ASTORIA ONLY

Romeo and Juliet · the ending

*E. Nesbit, Beautiful Stories from Shakespeare (Chicago: Hertel, Jenkins & Co., 1907), "Romeo and Juliet," **pp. 112–118**. Text: Project Gutenberg #1430. Public domain. The rest of the story, from where Week 7 stopped. · This packet: pp. 32–33*

> **Pre-read.** Deaths of Mercutio and Tybalt; the sleeping draught; both lovers die. Gentle option: read to the end of the paragraph about the rope-ladder ("…when they should meet again") and tell the rest in two sentences.

But that very day a dreadful thing happened.

Tybalt, the young man who had been so vexed at Romeo's going to the Capulet's feast, met him and his two friends, Mercutio and Benvolio, in the street, called Romeo a villain, and asked him to fight. Romeo had no wish to fight with Juliet's cousin, but Mercutio drew his sword, and he and Tybalt fought. And Mercutio was killed. When Romeo saw that this friend was dead, he forgot everything except anger at the man who had killed him, and he and Tybalt fought till Tybalt fell dead.

So, on the very day of his wedding, Romeo killed his dear Juliet's cousin, and was sentenced to be banished. Poor Juliet and her young husband met that night indeed; he climbed the rope-ladder among the flowers, and found her window, but their meeting was a sad one, and they parted with bitter tears and hearts heavy, because they could not know when they should meet again.

Now Juliet's father, who, of course, had no idea that she was married, wished her to wed a gentleman named Paris, and was so angry when she refused, that she hurried away to ask Friar Laurence what she should do. He advised her to pretend to consent, and then he said:

"I will give you a draught that will make you seem to be dead for two days, and then when they take you to church it will be to bury you, and not to marry you. They will put you in the vault thinking you are dead, and before you wake up Romeo and I will be there to take care of you. Will you do this, or are you afraid?"

"I will do it; talk not to me of fear!" said Juliet. And she went home and told her father she would marry Paris. If she had spoken out and told her father the truth . . . well, then this would have been a different story.

Lord Capulet was very much pleased to get his own way, and set about inviting his friends and getting the wedding feast ready. Everyone stayed up all night, for there was a great deal to do, and very little time to do it in. Lord Capulet was anxious to get Juliet married because he saw she was very unhappy. Of course she was really fretting about her husband Romeo, but her father thought she was grieving for the death of her cousin Tybalt, and he thought marriage would give her something else to think about.

Early in the morning the nurse came to call Juliet, and to dress her for her wedding; but she would not wake, and at last the nurse cried out suddenly—

"Alas! alas! help! help! my lady's dead! Oh, well-a-day that ever I was born!"

Lady Capulet came running in, and then Lord Capulet, and Lord Paris, the bridegroom. There lay Juliet cold and white and lifeless, and all their weeping could not wake her. So it was a burying that day instead of a marrying. Meantime Friar Laurence had sent a messenger to Mantua with a letter to Romeo telling him of all these things; and all would have been well, only the messenger was delayed, and could not go.

But ill news travels fast. Romeo's servant who knew the secret of the marriage, but not of Juliet's pretended death, heard of her funeral, and hurried to Mantua to tell Romeo how his young wife was dead and lying in the grave.

"Is it so?" cried Romeo, heart-broken. "Then I will lie by Juliet's side to-night."

And he bought himself a poison, and went straight back to Verona. He hastened to the tomb where Juliet was lying. It was not a grave, but a vault. He broke open the door, and was just going down the stone steps that led to the vault where all the dead Capulets lay, when he heard a voice behind him calling on him to stop.

It was the Count Paris, who was to have married Juliet that very day.

“How dare you come here and disturb the dead bodies of the Capulets, you vile Montagu?” cried Paris.

Poor Romeo, half mad with sorrow, yet tried to answer gently.

“You were told,” said Paris, “that if you returned to Verona you must die.”

“I must indeed,” said Romeo. “I came here for nothing else. Good, gentle youth—leave me! Oh, go—before I do you any harm! I love you better than myself—go—leave me here—”

Then Paris said, “I defy you, and I arrest you as a felon,” and Romeo, in his anger and despair, drew his sword. They fought, and Paris was killed.

As Romeo’s sword pierced him, Paris cried—

“Oh, I am slain! If thou be merciful, open the tomb, and lay me with Juliet!”

And Romeo said, “In faith I will.”

And he carried the dead man into the tomb and laid him by the dear Juliet’s side. Then he kneeled by Juliet and spoke to her, and held her in his arms, and kissed her cold lips, believing that she was dead, while all the while she was coming nearer and nearer to the time of her awakening. Then he drank the poison, and died beside his sweetheart and wife.

Now came Friar Laurence when it was too late, and saw all that had happened—and then poor Juliet woke out of her sleep to find her husband and her friend both dead beside her.

The noise of the fight had brought other folks to the place too, and Friar Laurence, hearing them, ran away, and Juliet was left alone. She saw the cup that had held the poison, and knew how all had happened, and since no poison was left for her, she drew her Romeo’s dagger and thrust it through her heart—and so, falling with her head on her Romeo’s breast, she died. And here ends the story of these faithful and most unhappy lovers.

> **End of Romeo and Juliet.** Narration can be one sentence: what went wrong, and why.

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · Ray's (Lesson 24) · Harvey's · *Understood Betsy* ch. 7 (printed, two sittings) · *Pilgrim's Progress* (printed) · copywork line for dictation · nature notebook · McGuffey nearby

8:00 — **Nature walk** TRACY JOINS

Twenty minutes. Pine cones, berries, one bird. Draw one thing later.

8:25 — **Bible · Luke 21:5–19**

Jesus speaks about the temple and hard days to come. Read once, narrate the main thread, stop.

8:40 — **Hymn or folk song** TRACY JOINS

Whichever she asks for.

8:50 — **Ray's · Lesson 24**

One lesson. Oral first. That finishes this week's four.

9:10 — **Harvey's · short sitting**

Second sitting of the week. Ten minutes.

9:25 — **Understood Betsy ch. 7 (first part)**

Printed. Read to the marked break (~20 min). Narrate. The rest this afternoon or next week.

9:55 — **Pilgrim's Progress**

Back to the wicket-gate. Printed, about 850 words. Narrate. Stop at "I rejoice and tremble."

10:15 — **Dictation (optional)**

Clapping her platter stood plump Bess, prepared, said once. Five minutes. Skip if she's tired.

How to teach Saturday

> **Luke, Betsy, and Pilgrim's Progress.** Harvey's second sitting. Evening walk if you can. It's October 31 — if the day is busy, keep Bible, Ray's, and Betsy, and let the rest go.

Bible

Luke 21:5–19. Open your ESV. People admire the temple; Jesus says it will come down, and tells his followers not to be frightened in hard times. One reading. Narrate the main thread.

Understood Betsy

Betsy, who used to be so frightened, fails her examination. That evening she has to get little Molly out of the Wolf Pit with no grown-up near. What she does then matters more than the test. Two sittings; ask what Betsy remembered about the examination by bedtime.

Pilgrim's Progress

Evangelist finishes his warning about Legality and Mr. Worldly Wiseman. Christian is sorry and asks if there is still hope. He goes back, knocks at the gate, and Good-will pulls him in, out of reach of the arrows from Beelzebub's castle. Next week Good-will talks with him inside the gate.

Dictation (optional)

Prepared dictation from *Clapping her platter stood plump Bess,* Five minutes.

Evening

A short walk in Lost Pines or around the yard. Nature notebook: one drawing, date it, scribe one sentence.

Tracy: nature, Bible as long as she'll sit, song, maybe Betsy listening. McGuffey during Ray's and Harvey's. Week 9 brings Exodus 19–20, Island Story ch. 29 (King Stephen), CHOW Knights from your copy, and Trial and Triumph (Anselm).

READ THIS · SATURDAY

Bible · Luke 21:5–19

ESV · open your physical copy · never reprint verse text

Open your ESV to Luke 21:5–19.

Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. Then stop.

Do not print or paste ESV (or any modern) Bible text — use the physical book only.
The temple and the hard days ahead. Read once, narrate the main thread.

Understood Betsy · Chapter 7 · Elizabeth Ann Fails in an Examination

*Dorothy Canfield Fisher, Understood Betsy (New York: Henry Holt, 1917), ch. VII, **pp. 137–161**. Text: Project Gutenberg #5347. Public domain. Full chapter, in two sittings. · This packet: pp. 37–42*

I wonder if you can guess the name of a little girl who, about a month after this, was walking along through the melting snow in the woods with a big black dog running circles around her. Yes, all alone in the woods with a terrible great dog beside her, and yet not a bit afraid. You don't suppose it could be Elizabeth Ann? Well, whoever she was, she had something on her mind, for she walked more and more slowly and had only a very absent-minded pat for the dog's head when he thrust it up for a caress. When the wood road led into a clearing in which there was a rough little house of slabs, the child stopped altogether, and, looking down, began nervously to draw lines in the snow with her overshoe.

You see, something perfectly dreadful had happened in school that day. The Superintendent, the all-important, seldom-seen Superintendent, came to visit the school and the children were given some examinations so he could see how they were getting on.

Now, you know what an examination did to Elizabeth Ann. Or haven't I told you yet?

Well, if I haven't, it's because words fail me. If there is anything horrid that an examination DIDn't do to Elizabeth Ann, I have yet to hear of it. It began years ago, before ever she went to school, when she heard Aunt Frances talking about how SHE had dreaded examinations when she was a child, and how they dried up her mouth and made her ears ring and her head ache and her knees get all weak and her mind a perfect blank, so that she didn't know what two and two made. Of course Elizabeth Ann didn't feel ALL those things right off at her first examination, but by the time she had had several and had rushed to tell Aunt Frances about how awful they were and the two of them had sympathized with one another and compared symptoms and then wept about her resulting low marks, why, she not only had all the symptoms Aunt Frances had ever had, but a good many more of her own invention.

Well, she had had them all and had them hard this afternoon, when the Superintendent was there. Her mouth had gone dry and her knees had shaken and her elbows had felt as though they had no more bones in them than so much jelly, and her eyes had smarted, and oh, what answers she had made! That dreadful tight panic had clutched at her throat whenever the Superintendent had looked at her, and she had disgraced herself ten times over. She went hot and cold to think of it, and felt quite sick with hurt vanity. She who did so well every day and was so much looked up to by her classmates, what MUST they be thinking of her! To tell the truth, she had been crying as she walked along through the woods, because she was so sorry for herself. Her eyes were all red still, and her throat sore from the big lump in it.

And now she would live it all over again as she told the Putney cousins. For of course they must be told. She had always told Aunt Frances everything that happened in school. It happened that Aunt Abigail had been taking a nap when she got home from school, and so she had come out to the sap-house, where Cousin Ann and Uncle Henry were making syrup, to have it over with as soon as possible. She went up to the little slab house now, dragging her feet and hanging her head, and opened the door.

Cousin Ann, in a very short old skirt and a man's coat and high rubber boots, was just poking some more wood into the big fire which blazed furiously under the broad, flat pan where the sap was boiling. The rough, brown hut was filled with white steam and that sweetest of all odors, hot maple syrup. Cousin Ann turned her head, her face very red with the heat of the fire, and nodded at the child.

"Hello, Betsy, you're just in time. I've saved out a cupful of hot syrup for you, all ready to wax."

Betsy hardly heard this, although she had been wild about waxed sugar on snow ever since her very first taste of it. “Cousin Ann,” she said unhappily, “the Superintendent visited our school this afternoon.”

“Did he!” said Cousin Ann, dipping a thermometer into the boiling syrup.

“Yes, and we had EXAMINATIONS!” said Betsy.

“Did you?” said Cousin Ann, holding the thermometer up to the light and looking at it.

“And you know how perfectly awful examinations make you feel,” said Betsy, very near to tears again.

“Why, no,” said Cousin Ann, sorting over syrup tins. “They never made me feel awful. I thought they were sort of fun.”

“FUN!” cried Betsy, indignantly, staring through the beginnings of her tears.

“Why, yes. Like taking a dare, don’t you know. Somebody stumps you to jump off the hitching-post, and you do it to show ’em. I always used to think examinations were like that. Somebody stumps you to spell ‘pneumonia,’ and you do it to show ’em. Here’s your cup of syrup. You’d better go right out and wax it while it’s hot.”

Elizabeth Ann automatically took the cup in her hand, but she did not look at it. “But supposing you get so scared you can’t spell ‘pneumonia’ or anything else!” she said feelingly. “That’s what happened to me. You know how your mouth gets all dry and your knees ...” She stopped. Cousin Ann had said she did NOT know all about those things. “Well, anyhow, I got so scared I could hardly STAND up! And I made the most awful mistakes—things I know just as WELL! I spelled ‘doubt’ without any b and ‘separate’ with an e, and I said Iowa was bounded on the north by Wisconsin, and I ...”

“Oh, well,” said Cousin Ann, “it doesn’t matter if you really know the right answers, does it? That’s the important thing.”

This was an idea which had never in all her life entered Betsy’s brain and she did not take it in at all now. She only shook her head miserably and went on in a doleful tone. “And I said 13 and 8 are 22! and I wrote March without any capital M, and I ...”

“Look here, Betsy, do you WANT to tell me all this?” Cousin Ann spoke in the quick, ringing voice she had once in a while which made everybody, from old Shep up, open his eyes and get his wits about him. Betsy gathered hers and thought hard; and she came to an unexpected conclusion. No, she didn’t really want to tell Cousin Ann all about it. Why was she doing it? Because she thought that was the thing to do. “Because if you don’t really want to,” went on Cousin Ann, “I don’t see that it’s doing anybody any good. I guess Hemlock Mountain will stand right there just the same even if you did forget to put a b in ‘doubt.’ And your syrup will be too cool to wax right if you don’t take it out pretty soon.”

She turned back to stoke the fire, and Elizabeth Ann, in a daze, found herself walking out of the door. It fell shut after her, and there she was under the clear, pale-blue sky, with the sun just hovering over the rim of Hemlock Mountain. She looked up at the big mountains, all blue and silver with shadows and snow, and wondered what in the world Cousin Ann had meant. Of course Hemlock Mountain would stand there just the same. But what of it? What did that have to do with her arithmetic, with anything? She had failed in her examination, hadn’t she?

She found a clean white snow-bank under a pine-tree, and, setting her cup of syrup down in a safe place, began to pat the snow down hard to make the right bed for the waxing of the syrup. The sun, very hot for that late March day, brought out strongly the tarry perfume of the big pine-tree. Near her the sap dripped musically into a bucket, already half full, hung on a maple-tree. A blue-jay rushed suddenly through the upper branches of the wood, his screaming and chattering voice sounding like noisy children at play.

Elizabeth Ann took up her cup and poured some of the thick, hot syrup out on the hard snow, making loops and curves as she poured. It stiffened and hardened at once, and she lifted up a great coil of it, threw her head back, and let it drop into her mouth. Concentrated sweetness of summer days was in that mouthful, part of it still hot and aromatic, part of it icy and wet with melting snow. She crunched it all together with her strong, child’s teeth into a

delicious, big lump and sucked on it dreamily, her eyes on the rim of Hemlock Mountain, high above her there, the snow on it bright golden in the sunlight. Uncle Henry had promised to take her up to the top as soon as the snow went off. She wondered what the top of a mountain would be like. Uncle Henry had said the main thing was that you could see so much of the world at once. He said it was too queer the way your own house and big barn and great fields looked like little toy things that weren't of any account. It was because you could see so much more than just the....

She heard an imploring whine, and a cold nose was thrust into her hand! Why, there was old Shep begging for his share of waxed sugar. He loved it, though it did stick to his teeth so! She poured out another lot and gave half of it to Shep. It immediately stuck his jaws together tight, and he began pawing at his mouth and shaking his head till Betsy had to laugh. Then he managed to pull his jaws apart and chewed loudly and visibly, tossing his head, opening his mouth wide till Betsy could see the sticky, brown candy draped in melting festoons all over his big white teeth and red gullet. Then with a gulp he had swallowed it all down and was whining for more, striking softly at the little girl's skirt with his forepaw. "Oh, you eat it too fast!" cried Betsy, but she shared her next lot with him too. The sun had gone down over Hemlock Mountain by this time, and the big slope above her was all deep blue shadow. The mountain looked much higher now as the dusk began to fall, and loomed up bigger and bigger as though it reached to the sky. It was no wonder houses looked small from its top. Betsy ate the last of her sugar, looking up at the quiet giant there, towering grandly above her. There was no lump in her throat now. And, although she still thought she did not know what in the world Cousin Ann meant by saying that about Hemlock Mountain and her examination, it's my opinion that she had made a very good beginning of an understanding.

> **Break here** for the first sitting. The rest can be read Saturday afternoon or next week.

SECOND SITTING

She was just picking up her cup to take it back to the sap-house when Shep growled a little and stood with his ears and tail up, looking down the road. Something was coming down that road in the blue, clear twilight, something that was making a very queer noise. It sounded almost like somebody crying. It WAS somebody crying! It was a child crying. It was a little, little girl.... Betsy could see her now ... stumbling along and crying as though her heart would break. Why, it was little Molly, her own particular charge at school, whose reading lesson she heard every day. Betsy and Shep ran to meet her. "What's the matter, Molly? What's the matter?" Betsy knelt down and put her arms around the weeping child. "Did you fall down? Did you hurt you? What are you doing 'way off here? Did you lose your way?"

"I don't want to go away! I don't want to go away!" said Molly over and over, clinging tightly to Betsy. It was a long time before Betsy could quiet her enough to find out what had happened. Then she made out between Molly's sobs that her mother had been taken suddenly sick and had to go away to a hospital, and that left nobody at home to take care of Molly, and she was to be sent away to some strange relatives in the city who didn't want her at all and who said so right out....

Oh, Elizabeth Ann knew all about that! and her heart swelled big with sympathy. For a moment she stood again out on the sidewalk in front of the Lathrop house with old Mrs. Lathrop's ungracious white head bobbing from a window, and knew again that ghastly feeling of being unwanted. Oh, she knew why little Molly was crying! And she shut her hands together hard and made up her mind that she WOULD help her out!

[Illustration: "What's the matter, Molly? What's the matter?"]

Do you know what she did, right off, without thinking about it? She didn't go and look up Aunt Abigail. She didn't wait till Uncle Henry came back from his round of emptying sap buckets into the big tub on his sled. As fast as her feet could carry her she flew back to Cousin Ann in the sap-house. I can't tell you (except again that Cousin Ann was Cousin Ann) why it was that Betsy ran so fast to her and was so sure that everything would be all right as soon as Cousin Ann knew about it; but whatever the reason was it was a good one, for, though Cousin Ann did not stop to kiss Molly or even to look at her more than one sharp first glance, she said after a moment's pause, during which she

filled a syrup can and screwed the cover down very tight: “Well, if her folks will let her stay, how would you like to have Molly come and stay with us till her mother gets back from the hospital? Now you’ve got a room of your own, I guess if you wanted to you could have her sleep with you.”

“Oh, Molly, Molly, Molly!” shouted Betsy, jumping up and down, and then hugging the little girl with all her might. “Oh, it will be like having a little sister!”

Cousin Ann sounded a dry, warning note: “Don’t be too sure her folks will let her. We don’t know about them yet.”

Betsy ran to her, and caught her hand, looking up at her with shining eyes. “Cousin Ann, if YOU go to see them and ask them, they will!”

This made even Cousin Ann give a little abashed smile of pleasure, although she made her face grave again at once and said: “You’d better go along back to the house now, Betsy. It’s time for you to help Mother with the supper.”

The two children trotted back along the darkening wood road, Shep running before them, little Molly clinging fast to the older child’s hand. “Aren’t you ever afraid, Betsy, in the woods this way?” she asked admiringly, looking about her with timid eyes.

“Oh, no!” said Betsy, protectingly; “there’s nothing to be afraid of, except getting off on the wrong fork of the road, near the Wolf Pit.”

“Oh, OW!” said Molly, cringing. “What’s the Wolf Pit? What an awful name!”

Betsy laughed. She tried to make her laugh sound brave like Cousin Ann’s, which always seemed so scornful of being afraid. As a matter of fact, she was beginning to fear that they HAD made the wrong turn, and she was not quite sure that she could find the way home. But she put this out of her mind and walked along very fast, peering ahead into the dusk. “Oh, it hasn’t anything to do with wolves,” she said in answer to Molly’s question; “anyhow, not now. It’s just a big, deep hole in the ground where a brook had dug out a cave.... Uncle Henry told me all about it when he showed it to me ... and then part of the roof caved in; sometimes there’s ice in the corner of the covered part all the summer, Aunt Abigail says.”

“Why do you call it the Wolf Pit?” asked Molly, walking very close to Betsy and holding very tightly to her hand.

“Oh, long, ever so long ago, when the first settlers came up here, they heard a wolf howling all night, and when it didn’t stop in the morning, they came up here on the mountain and found a wolf had fallen in and couldn’t get out.”

“My! I hope they killed him!” said Molly.

“Oh, gracious! that was more than a hundred years ago,” said Betsy. She was not thinking of what she was saying. She was thinking that if they WERE on the right road they ought to be home by this time. She was thinking that the right road ran down hill to the house all the way, and that this certainly seemed to be going up a little. She was wondering what had become of Shep. “Stand here just a minute, Molly,” she said. “I want ... I just want to go ahead a little bit and see ... and see ...” She darted on around a curve of the road and stood still, her heart sinking. The road turned there and led straight up the mountain!

For just a moment the little girl felt a wild impulse to burst out in a shriek for Aunt Frances, and to run crazily away, anywhere so long as she was running. But the thought of Molly standing back there, trustfully waiting to be taken care of, shut Betsy’s lips together hard before her scream of fright got out. She stood still, thinking. Now she mustn’t get frightened. All they had to do was to walk back along the road till they came to the fork and then make the right turn. But what if they didn’t get back to the turn till it was so dark they couldn’t see it...? Well, she mustn’t think of that. She ran back, calling, “Come on, Molly,” in a tone she tried to make as firm as Cousin Ann’s. “I guess we have made the wrong turn after all. We’d better ...”

But there was no Molly there. In the brief moment Betsy had stood thinking, Molly had disappeared. The long, shadowy wood road held not a trace of her.

Then Betsy WAS frightened and then she DID begin to scream, at the top of her voice, “Molly! Molly!” She was beside herself with terror, and started back hastily to hear Molly’s voice, very faint, apparently coming from the ground under her feet.

“Ow! Ow! Betsy! Get me out! Get me out!”

“Where ARE you?” shrieked Betsy.

“I don’t know!” came Molly’s sobbing voice. “I just moved the least little bit out of the road, and slipped on the ice and began to slide and I couldn’t stop myself and I fell down into a deep hole!”

Betsy’s head felt as though her hair were standing up straight on end with horror. Molly must have fallen down into the Wolf Pit! Yes, they were quite near it. She remembered now that big white-birch tree stood right at the place where the brook tumbled over the edge and fell into it. Although she was dreadfully afraid of falling in herself, she went cautiously over to this tree, feeling her way with her foot to make sure she did not slip, and peered down into the cavernous gloom below. Yes, there was Molly’s little face, just a white speck. The child was crying, sobbing, and holding up her arms to Betsy.

“Are you hurt, Molly?”

“No. I fell into a big snow-bank, but I’m all wet and frozen and I want to get out! I want to get out!”

Betsy held on to the birch-tree. Her head whirled. What SHOULD she do! “Look here, Molly,” she called down, “I’m going to run back along to the right road and back to the house and get Uncle Henry. He’ll come with a rope and get you out!”

At this Molly’s crying rose to a frantic scream. “Oh, Betsy, don’t leave me here alone! Don’t! Don’t! The wolves will get me! Betsy, DON’T leave me alone!” The child was wild with terror.

“But I CAN’T get you out myself!” screamed back Betsy, crying herself. Her teeth were chattering with the cold.

“Don’t go! Don’t go!” came up from the darkness of the pit in a piteous howl. Betsy made a great effort and stopped crying. She sat down on a stone and tried to think. And this is what came into her mind as a guide: “What would Cousin Ann do if she were here? She wouldn’t cry. She would THINK of something.”

Betsy looked around her desperately. The first thing she saw was the big limb of a pine-tree, broken off by the wind, which half lay and half slantingly stood up against a tree a little distance above the mouth of the pit. It had been there so long that the needles had all dried and fallen off, and the skeleton of the branch with the broken stubs looked like ... yes, it looked like a ladder! THAT was what Cousin Ann would have done!

“Wait a minute! Wait a minute, Molly!” she called wildly down the pit, warm all over in excitement. “Now listen. You go off there in a corner, where the ground makes a sort of roof. I’m going to throw down something you can climb up on, maybe.”

“Ow! Ow, it’ll hit me!” cried poor little Molly, more and more frightened. But she scrambled off under her shelter obediently, while Betsy struggled with the branch. It was so firmly imbedded in the snow that at first she could not budge it at all. But after she cleared that away and pried hard with the stick she was using as a lever she felt it give a little. She bore down with all her might, throwing her weight again and again on her lever, and finally felt the big branch perceptibly move. After that it was easier, as its course was down hill over the snow to the mouth of the pit. Glowing, and pushing, wet with perspiration, she slowly maneuvered it along to the edge, turned it squarely, gave it a great shove, and leaned over anxiously. Then she gave a great sigh of relief! Just as she had hoped, it went down sharp end first and stuck fast in the snow which had saved Molly from broken bones. She was so out of breath with her work that for a moment she could not speak. Then, “Molly, there! Now I guess you can climb up to where I can reach you.”

Molly made a rush for any way out of her prison, and climbed, like the little practiced squirrel that she was, up from one stub to another to the top of the branch. She was still below the edge of the pit there, but Betsy lay flat down on the snow and held out her hands. Molly took hold hard, and, digging her toes into the snow, slowly wormed her way

up to the surface of the ground.

It was then, at that very moment, that Shep came bounding up to them, barking loudly, and after him Cousin Ann striding along in her rubber boots, with a lantern in her hand and a rather anxious look on her face.

She stopped short and looked at the two little girls, covered with snow, their faces flaming with excitement, and at the black hole gaping behind them. “I always TOLD Father we ought to put a fence around that pit,” she said in a matter-of-fact voice. “Some day a sheep’s going to fall down there. Shep came along to the house without you, and we thought most likely you’d taken the wrong turn.”

Betsy felt terribly aggrieved. She wanted to be petted and praised for her heroism. She wanted Cousin Ann to REALIZE ... oh, if Aunt Frances were only there, SHE would realize...!

“I fell down in the hole, and Betsy wanted to go and get Mr. Putney, but I wouldn’t let her, and so she threw down a big branch and I climbed out,” explained Molly, who, now that her danger was past, took Betsy’s action quite as a matter of course.

“Oh, that was how it happened,” said Cousin Ann. She looked down the hole and saw the big branch, and looked back and saw the long trail of crushed snow where Betsy had dragged it. “Well, now, that was quite a good idea for a little girl to have,” she said briefly. “I guess you’ll do to take care of Molly all right!”

She spoke in her usual voice and immediately drew the children after her, but Betsy’s heart was singing joyfully as she trotted along clasping Cousin Ann’s strong hand. Now she knew that Cousin Ann realized.... She trotted fast, smiling to herself in the darkness.

“What made you think of doing that?” asked Cousin Ann presently, as they approached the house.

“Why, I tried to think what YOU would have done if you’d been there,” said Betsy.

“Oh!” said Cousin Ann. “Well ...”

She didn’t say another word, but Betsy, glancing up into her face as they stepped into the lighted room, saw an expression that made her give a little skip and hop of joy. She had PLEASED Cousin Ann.

That night, as she lay in her bed, her arm over Molly cuddled up warm beside her, she remembered, oh, ever so faintly, as something of no importance, that she had failed in an examination that afternoon.

> **End of chapter 7.** Next week: chapter 8, Betsy Starts a Sewing Society.

READ THIS · SATURDAY

The Pilgrim’s Progress · Back to the wicket-gate

John Bunyan, The Pilgrim’s Progress (London: J. M. Dent; New York: E. P. Dutton, 1910 edition, illustrated by Frank C. Papé), ***pp. 25–28****. Text: Project Gutenberg #131 (bracketed Scripture references and section numbers removed). Public domain. About 850 words. · This packet: pp. 43–44*

He to whom thou wast sent for ease, being by name Legality, is the son of the bond-woman which now is, and is in bondage with her children; and is, in a mystery, this Mount Sinai, which thou hast feared will fall on thy head. Now, if she, with her children, are in bondage, how canst thou expect by them to be made free? This Legality, therefore, is not able to set thee free from thy burden. No man was as yet ever rid of his burden by him; no, nor ever is like to be: ye cannot be justified by the works of the law; for by the deeds of the law no man living can be rid of his burden: therefore, Mr. Worldly Wiseman is an alien, and Mr. Legality is a cheat; and for his son Civility, notwithstanding his simpering looks, he is but a hypocrite and cannot help thee. Believe me, there is nothing in all this noise, that thou hast heard of these sottish men, but a design to beguile thee of thy salvation, by turning thee from the way in which I had set thee. After this, Evangelist called aloud to the heavens for confirmation of what he had said: and with that there came words and fire out of the mountain under which poor Christian stood, that made the hair of his flesh stand up. The words were thus pronounced: ‘As many as are of the works of the law are under the curse; for it is written, Cursed is every one that continueth not in all things which are written in the book of the law to do them.’

Now Christian looked for nothing but death, and began to cry out lamentably; even cursing the time in which he met with Mr. Worldly Wiseman; still calling himself a thousand fools for hearkening to his counsel; he also was greatly ashamed to think that this gentleman’s arguments, flowing only from the flesh, should have the prevalency with him as to cause him to forsake the right way. This done, he applied himself again to Evangelist in words and sense as follow:

CHR. Sir, what think you? Is there hope? May I now go back and go up to the wicket-gate? Shall I not be abandoned for this, and sent back from thence ashamed? I am sorry I have hearkened to this man’s counsel. But may my sin be forgiven?

EVAN. Then said Evangelist to him, Thy sin is very great, for by it thou hast committed two evils: thou hast forsaken the way that is good, to tread in forbidden paths; yet will the man at the gate receive thee, for he has goodwill for men; only, said he, take heed that thou turn not aside again, ‘lest thou perish from the way, when his wrath is kindled but a little.’ Then did Christian address himself to go back; and Evangelist, after he had kissed him, gave him one smile, and bid him God-speed. So he went on with haste, neither spake he to any man by the way; nor, if any asked him, would he vouchsafe them an answer. He went like one that was all the while treading on forbidden ground, and could by no means think himself safe, till again he was got into the way which he left, to follow Mr. Worldly Wiseman’s counsel. So, in process of time, Christian got up to the gate. Now, over the gate there was written, ‘Knock, and it shall be opened unto you.’

“He that will enter in must first without Stand knocking at the Gate, nor need he doubt That is A KNOCKER but to enter in; For God can love him, and forgive his sin.”

He knocked, therefore, more than once or twice, saying—

“May I now enter here? Will he within Open to sorry me, though I have been An undeserving rebel? Then shall I Not fail to sing his lasting praise on high.”

At last there came a grave person to the gate, named Good-will, who asked who was there? and whence he came? and what he would have?

CHR. Here is a poor burdened sinner. I come from the City of Destruction, but am going to Mount Zion, that I may be delivered from the wrath to come. I would therefore, Sir, since I am informed that by this gate is the way thither, know if you are willing to let me in?

GOOD-WILL. I am willing with all my heart, said he; and with that he opened the gate.

So when Christian was stepping in, the other gave him a pull. Then said Christian, What means that? The other told him. A little distance from this gate, there is erected a strong castle, of which Beelzebub is the captain; from thence, both he and them that are with him shoot arrows at those that come up to this gate, if haply they may die before they can enter in.

Then said Christian, I rejoice and tremble.

> **Stop here.** Next week: Good-will talks with Christian inside the gate.

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Harvey’s Elementary Grammar · short sitting

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

Open Harvey’s to your place.

About ten minutes. Oral and light. Second sitting of the week. Stop.

Do not dump the book.

HOLD ALL WEEK · FROM YOUR SHELF

Ray’s New Practical Arithmetic · Lessons 21–24

Mott Media reprint · owned copy · never reprinted

One lesson each school day.

Wednesday Lesson 21 · Thursday Lesson 22 · Friday Lesson 23 · Saturday Lesson 24.

Oral first when the book allows. Stop after one lesson. Tracy: McGuffey picture-pages nearby.

Do not dump the book. Never reprint Mott text.

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After Bible, Wed and Thu only.

Ten to fifteen minutes. Next page or section in their physical Awana book. Then put it away.

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